Nadia Brennan-Aziz

Senior Platform Engineer

Professional Summary

Platform engineer and technical lead with experience designing, building and operating AWS infrastructure, production EKS platforms and infrastructure as code. Delivered developer-platform improvements adopted by 14 product teams, reduced cloud costs and established service-level objectives with product leadership. Previously supported game backends serving over a million daily players, including capacity planning for major launches.

Technical Skills

Cloud infrastructure: AWS, EKS, ECS, RDS, SQS, S3, EC2, AWS Spot

Infrastructure as code: Terraform, Atlantis, Crossplane

Service deployment: Kubernetes, Helm, Argo CD, ApplicationSets, GitHub Actions

Observability and reliability: Prometheus, Alertmanager, Grafana, Sloth, PagerDuty, SLOs, burn-rate alerts, capacity planning, k6

Development: Go, Python, controller-runtime

Technical leadership: Platform design, developer enablement, stakeholder collaboration, mentoring

Professional Experience

Senior Platform Engineer | Tallybrook Ltd | 2022-Present

Technical lead of the platform team, covering the EKS platform, internal developer platform, SLOs and cloud costs.

- Built golden-path service templates in Go and Python, Argo CD ApplicationSets and Crossplane compositions for RDS, SQS and S3 provisioned through pull requests. Reduced time from new service to production from approximately two weeks to under one day; adopted by all 14 product teams.
- Used EKS, Helm, Terraform, GitHub Actions and the Backstage catalog to support the internal developer platform.
- Replaced cluster-autoscaler-managed node groups with Karpenter and introduced AWS Spot for stateless workloads with interruption handling. Reduced EC2 spend by 38%, approximately GBP 410,000 annually.
- Established SLOs and burn-rate alerts for the 20 most critical services using Prometheus recording rules and Sloth. Reduced weekly pages by approximately 60% and agreed an error budget policy with product leadership.
- Mentored three backend engineers transitioning into SRE.

Site Reliability Engineer | Brightwater Games | 2019-2022

- Supported game backends during launches with over a million daily players; operated production EKS from 2020.
- Moved AWS infrastructure fully into Terraform with Atlantis and replaced Nagios alerting with Prometheus and Alertmanager.
- Led capacity planning for two major launches. In 2020, used k6 load tests simulating 300,000 concurrent players to identify and fix a connection pool limit before launch.

Additional Projects and Contributions

Open-source Kubernetes cleanup controller | 2024

- Built a Go controller using controller-runtime to delete expired preview namespaces; approximately 120 GitHub stars.

UK DevOps meetup speaker | 2024

- Presented "SLOs that product managers care about".

Certification

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)